# CHOOSING A TECH 4 DESTINATION

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With the fast-approaching culmination of studies here at EPITECH, I am very much looking forward to starting a journey that will increase my knowledge, add to my cultural understanding, and extend my career opportunities. The University of California, San Diego, is an outstanding institution where these goals can be accomplished; it offers both an intellectually sound atmosphere and the type of cross-cultural exposure I seek.

Being part of the University of California, UCSD is among the ten campuses that are globally known for their academic excellence and set high standards. This institution was ranked 15th in the world according to the Shanghai Jiao Tong University ranking for the year 2012. In the areas of Computer Science, Engineering, and Business. Studying from faculty experts in areas related to Software Development, Web Development, Distributed Computing, and Bioinformatics will be particularly interesting for me. The class scope fully aligns with my goals in TECH 4.

However, what was even more appealing is the fact that UCSD's UPS allows a combination of university and extension courses. Courses selected in the structure of the CSE department allows me to stay on this track of hands-on methods of learning, very similar to the methodology at EPITECH. Project-based courses, such as CSE 120-Principles of Operating Systems and CSE 131-Compiler Construction, promise a very dynamic learning environment, which I have always been able to enjoy. The hands-on approaches will add to my acquired practical knowledge and better equip me.

Apart from the technical studies, UCSD's three-quarter program includes a Certificate in Business Administration, culminating in a quarter that is project-based and applied in nature with American companies. Nothing can replace the experience that I will get by working practically with U.S.-based companies. Not only will it enhance my learning of business, but also it will give me valuable networking opportunities by which I will learn about the American tech industry and enhance my international network. In the technological world today, a grasp of both technical and business outlooks is very important. UCSD's program addresses this important aspect accordingly.

The University of California, San Diego, has its campus in La Jolla, San Diego. The campus is eventful and has lots of social, cultural, and recreational opportunities. With over 29,000 students in total, UCSD boasts of a very diverse student population, hence great avenues for cross-cultural interaction. The excellent sports and recreational facilities at UCSD include swimming pools, tennis courts, and gyms that create an amazing balance in the student's life one will lead, hence assuring a well-rounded experience.

While studying at UCSD offers excellent academic and cultural opportunities, I must also plan for the financial responsibilities associated with this. EPITECH will cover part of the tuition fee in the fourth year but another tuition supplement of an estimated extra cost for

housing, insurance, and daily expenses amounting to around $2,000 per month will be at my expense. Fortunately, UCSD offers economic housing, such as the Anatolia residences that come with a gym and a swimming pool, thus making it very comfortable. In addition, UCSD permits part-time on-campus work for international students, and this will be a great way in managing my expenses during my stay while building valuable work experience. The application and process of getting a visa to UCSD will be difficult but achievable. The application also requires the proof of English proficiency and financial resources, together with a comprehensive submission including selected courses. I fully trust that with the support from EPITECH and the guidance from UCSD, I would be fulfilling those requirements. An F-1 student visa, admitting to study and working part-time on campus will be applied for upon admission.

I am very motivated to seek an opportunity at the University of California, San Diego, as UCSD offers an excellent academic environment. At UCSD, I will be gaining technical skills, insights into business practices, and intercultural experience that will prepare me for success in the global technology industry. I am eager to immerse myself in American culture. Undoubtedly, my time here at UCSD will be transformative: it will equip me with the skills, knowledge, and perspective needed for excellence.